Project Pathfinder: New Home

Game Concept:

Project Pathfinder: New Home is a roguelite space shooter game that combines the classic gameplay of Warblade with elements from popular roguelite titles such as Hades, Slay the Spire, Darkest Dungeons, and Returnal. Players assume the role of a group of scientists who have created a wormhole-generating machine to find a new home for humankind as Earth faces its demise. The objective is to navigate through a series of procedurally generated galaxies, each consisting of multiple levels organized in a tree structure. Defeat challenging bosses at the end of each galaxy to progress to the next, ultimately reaching the final galaxy where humanity's new home planet awaits. The game features persistent progression, strategic decision-making, and a visually stunning 3D art style inspired by games like Alienation and Helldivers.

Gameplay Overview:

- Genre: Roguelite space shooter
- Perspective: Top-down view
- Platform: PC, consoles

Story:

In the not-too-distant future, Earth is on the brink of destruction due to environmental catastrophes. A group of brilliant scientists develops a breakthrough technology known as the Pathfinder, a machine capable of creating stable wormholes. With this technology, humanity embarks on a perilous journey to find a new planet to call home.

Game Mechanics:

- Ship Control: Players control a spacecraft equipped with advanced weaponry and maneuvering capabilities. The ship can move freely in all directions, dodge enemy attacks, and perform evasive maneuvers.
- Wormhole Travel: Players use the Pathfinder machine to create wormholes that transport them to different procedurally generated galaxies. Each galaxy represents a distinct theme and consists of multiple levels organized in a tree structure.
- Combat: Engage in intense shoot 'em up combat with various enemy types, including hostile alien creatures and rival space-faring factions. Collect resources and defeat enemies to upgrade your ship's weapons, shields, and abilities.
- Resource Management: Collect resources scattered throughout the levels to upgrade your ship, purchase new weapons, and repair damage sustained during battles. Persistent resources obtained during previous runs can be used to upgrade your ship before starting a new run, ensuring continued progression even after death.
- Progression and Upgrades: Utilize resources to upgrade ship attributes, unlock new weapons, and improve abilities. Make strategic decisions on which upgrades to prioritize, creating unique synergies and playstyles.
- Strategic Decision-Making: Explore the galaxies by navigating through branching paths and making choices on which levels to tackle within each galaxy. Each level presents different challenges and rewards, allowing players to tailor their progression to their preferred playstyle.
- Perks and Abilities: Discover and unlock unique perks and abilities that grant your ship special powers, enhancing its firepower, defense, mobility, or granting special abilities. Experiment with different combinations to find the most effective strategy for each level.
- Galactic Boss Battles: At the end of each galaxy, players face challenging boss battles that test their skills and strategies. Defeating the boss unlocks progress to the next galaxy, bringing humankind closer to their new home planet.

Level Design:

- Procedural Generation: Each galaxy features procedurally generated levels, offering a unique layout, enemy placement, and resource distribution. This ensures replayability and presents new challenges in every run.
- Tree Structure: Levels within each galaxy are organized in a tree structure, providing branching paths and choices for progression. Players start at the root of the tree and navigate through the levels, making decisions on which branches to explore.
- Galactic Themes: Each galaxy represents a distinct theme, such as alien planets, asteroid fields,

derelict space stations, and more. The themes influence the environmental hazards, obstacles, and atmospheric challenges encountered.
- Boss Fights: At the end of each galaxy, players face challenging boss battles that require strategic planning and skillful execution. Defeating the bosses unlocks progress to the next galaxy and brings humanity closer to their new home planet.

Art Style:

The game features a visually stunning 3D art style inspired by games like Alienation and Helldivers. The environments, ships, and enemies are meticulously crafted in 3D, creating a rich and immersive game world. The art style emphasizes detailed and intricate designs, with a focus on futuristic aesthetics, vibrant colors, and dynamic lighting effects. The neon lights play a prominent role, casting a surreal and atmospheric glow that adds to the intense action and futuristic setting of the game.

Appeal and Target Audience:

Project Pathfinder: New Home is designed to appeal to a broad range of players who enjoy immersive space shooters, roguelite mechanics, strategic decision-making, and persistent progression. The game combines the thrill of intense shoot 'em up combat with the strategic depth of planning and upgrading your ship for optimal performance. The branching paths, procedural generation, and diverse galaxy themes offer replayability and keep players

engaged in their quest for a new home planet. The inclusion of strategic decision-making and the ability to shape your ship's upgrades and abilities cater to players who enjoy experimenting with different playstyles and creating powerful synergies. The visually stunning 3D art style, inspired by games like Alienation and Helldivers, adds to the game's appeal and creates a visually striking and immersive experience.

With its captivating gameplay, strategic depth, persistent progression, and visually stunning art style, Project Pathfinder: New Home aims to captivate players and provide an exciting and rewarding space shooter experience.